

# Humans on the ice

For thousands of years, the most effective hunters on the sea ice have been human—the Inuit, Yupik, and other Arctic peoples. Until recently these hunters were entirely self-sufficient, using equipment crafted from the skins and bones of their prey. Although they now also use a lot of modern technology, many still live by hunting.

## KEEPING WARM

In winter, the temperature in the Arctic rarely rises above freezing point and can plunge to below  $-58^{\circ}\text{F}$  ( $-50^{\circ}\text{C}$ ). These Inuit are used to the chill, but they could not survive without their extra-warm clothes made of furry animal skins. Traditionally, the warmest clothes were made of caribou (reindeer) skins, but sealskin and even polar bear fur were also used.



WOW!

Inside their igloos, Inuit hunters would sleep on beds made of solid ice, which were covered with furry caribou skins.

## SNOW HOUSES

In the past, many Arctic people lived in houses made of stones, animal bones, and driftwood, or animal-skin tents in summer. But Inuit hunters staying out on the sea ice in winter would camp for the night in small shelters made of snow blocks called igloos. The walls of snow kept out the bitterly cold wind, while the heat from the sleeping people kept the inside surprisingly warm. The Inuit still build igloos when hunting, but their families usually live in modern-style homes.

